

# ZHENFENG ZHOU

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Last Update: March 2026

## Education

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### Nanjing University

Nanjing, China

M.A. in Computational Communication; GPA: 4.6/5

2023–present

Relevant Coursework: Causal Inference, Advanced Statistics, Data Collection and Processing, Text Data Analysis

### Lanzhou University

Lanzhou, China

B.A. in Journalism and Communications (graduated with honors); GPA: 4.0/5

2019–2023

Relevant Coursework: Data Analysis, Social Statistics, Logic, Communication Research

## Research interests

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- Computational social science and Computational communication
- Human narratives in language
- Computational text analysis and Causal inference
- Media psychology

## Working papers

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- [1] **Zhou, Z.**, Liu, Y., Xiao, X., & Wang, C.J.\* (2025). The Unintended Consequences of Emancipation: The Abolition of Slavery and the Rise of Racist Narratives in Southern U.S. Newspapers (1800-1920). <https://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5244337> Paper presented at *the 111th Annual National Communication Association Conference (NCA)*, Denver, USA, 2025. Latest paper will be presented at the 76th Annual International Communication Association Conference (ICA), Cape Town, South Africa, 2026.
- [2] Liu, Y., **Zhou, Z.**, & Wang, C.J.\* (2025). Unpacking the Black Box of Hostility: Threat Perception, Moral Judgement, and Aggressive Rhetoric in China's Diplomatic Press Conferences. Paper presented at *the 75th Annual International Communication Association Conference (ICA)*, Denver, USA, 2025.
- [3] Sun, Y., **Zhou, Z.**, & Wang, C.J.\* (2024). Building Identity Through Narratives: Who Voices Dissent Within the Party? Paper presented at *the 107th Annual Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication Conference (AEJMC)*, Philadelphia, USA, 2024.

## Publications

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- [4] **Zhou, Z.**, & Ma, Z.\* (2025). Evaluating the Brief Resilience Scale in 21 Countries: Psychometric Properties and Measurement Invariance Across Sex, Age, and Countries. *Assessment*. Accepted in August 2025.
- [5] **Zhou, Z.**, & Ma, Z.\* (2025). Understanding the Co-occurrence of Depressive and Anxiety Symptoms Among 2021 Henan Flood Victims Through Panel Network Analysis: A 6-Month, Three - Wave Longitudinal Study. *Journal of Clinical Psychology*. Accepted in October 2025.

## Honors and awards

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- National Encouragement Scholarship for Undergraduate Student Oct 2020
- National Encouragement Scholarship for Undergraduate Student Oct 2021
- Internet+ College Students Innovation and Entrepreneurship Competition (Bronze Medalist) May 2022
- International Genetically Engineered Machine Competition (Gold Medalist) Oct 2022
- Graduate Academic First-Class Award (¥12,000) Nov 2024
- The 10th China National Conference on Big Data and Social Computing (Second prize ¥5000) Aug 2025
- Sun Xiangzhen Award (¥8000) Aug 2025

## Selected projects

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**US Historical Newspapers Database Project** 2023 – 2024  
¥6000, Leader

- Collected and digitized 19th-century U.S. newspapers and extracted structured information.
- Built a structured database for text mining and quantitative historical analysis.
- Implemented Python scripts for large-scale data cleaning and preprocessing.

**Classification and Prediction of China-Related Sentiment in X Texts** Aug. 2025 – Dec. 2025  
¥3000, with supervisor

- Large-scale collection of China-related tweets from the X platform.
- Coded using LLMs with dual validation through human coding.
- Trained models using BERT on the dataset and produced a high-performing model.

**Distinguished Postgraduate Talent Cultivation Program** 2024 – 2026  
¥6000, Collaborator

- Collected and analyzed corpora of Chinese MFA spokesperson press conferences.
- Applied embedding-based NLP methods to detect semantic patterns in diplomatic discourse.

## Skills

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- **Statistical Programming:** Python, R, Stata, HTML/CSS
- **Languages:** Mandarin (Native), English
- **Applications:** Qualtrics, Amazon Mechanical Turk, Photoshop, Premier Pro, Audition
- **Sports and Hobbies:** Badminton, Cycling, and Photography